

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK - POURED CEMENT RAILWAY COTTAGES



Housing had been a difficulty in the town since its inception. Workshops had been relocated from Port Pirie in 1891, and the influx of 60 workers caused a huge shortage of accommodation. Many families were crowded into shared boarding houses or lived on the outskirts of the town in tents. Other workers lived permanently in hotels.

The planned expansion of the Railways in Peterborough and relocation of the paint and repair shops from Quorn in 1925, exacerbated the shortage of housing in the town.

The matter was brought before parliament by Mr M.H. O'Halloran who asked the Chief Commissioner if he was aware that many railway employees were unable to obtain houses in Peterborough and was it the intention of the premier to consider the advisability of building a number of railway cottages there. The Premier the Hon J. Gunn replying to Mr O'Halloran in the Assembly, stated that the Railways Commissioner hoped to complete two hundred cottages for employees at Peterborough by June 30, 1926.

The Railways purchased an area known as Hill View owned by Mr Cochrane west of Peterborough. Housing lots were laid out with two hundred cottages to be built at a cost of £700 each. These cottages were made of poured cement and over 200 workers were employed to build them.

By 28th February 1926, twelve of these cottages were ready. The workers relocated from Quorn were given preference for these cottages. Forty-five more were completed by September 1926 with a further thirty more waiting for tanks, wire doors and fencing. Railway workers were charged £1 per week for rent with 6d for water and 9d for use of electric lights. Power meters were installed in 1936. These cottages had five rooms with conveniences such as bathrooms, wash troughs and coppers connected with rain water tanks. They were also provided with septic tanks, water and electric lights. By September seventy-five of the poured cement houses were built on the Hill View Estate with a further thirty-five completed by the end of 1926.

Although it was proposed to build two hundred of these cottages, only one hundred and ten were actually built. The remaining cottages were to be built south of Buxton Crescent, but this never eventuated.

Out of the all the cottages built there are three different floorplans although there were several different shapes and frontages. Most of the cottages built in Railway Terrace, Queen Street, Wright Street, and Princess Street are of a square shape with either a flat roofed front porch or a gabled porch, although some houses have the porch on the side. The cottages in Buxton Crescent and some in Wright Street are a longer shape with stone pillars on their porches. The cottages in Buxton Crescent have more enate thinner pillars. In the longer shaped houses the third bedroom is accessible through the lounge room.

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In 1926 a red brick church was built by the Baptists in Hill View along the new road (Queen Street which was just a dirt track) to the Railway cottages to service the residents. The church was opened on Sunday 3rd April 1927 and services continued until it closed around 1951.

A Methodist Church was built in Hill Street and opened in 1927 with an addition of a hall to be used as a Sunday school. This building was made of wood and iron. In 1952 the brick church built by the Baptist Church was purchased by the Methodist Church.

In 1952 the old iron Methodist Church and Hall were moved from its Hill Street site adjacent to the church in Queen Street on the Cyanide Street side. The church was pushed by railwaymen, church members and the New Australian workforce on a specially constructed railway line, and was done over two weekends. This was used as the Sunday School. The church was reopened on Saturday 16th August 1952. A kitchen was added to the Hall in 1955. The original iron church was sold in 1969 and removed. The Peterborough West Methodist Church was closed on 29th May 1976 and was sold in 1984.

A committee was formed and the residents of the new railway cottages held a fete on 19th December 1927 to raise money for swings and equipment for the children's playground.

A shop was opened in Queen Street around 1927 by Mr Sexton and the tennis courts were opened in February 1928.

*Below - West Baptist Church
Photo - Lionel Noble Collection*



*Above - West Methodist Church
Photo - Lionel Noble Collection*

New Railway Cottages 1930 Commonwealth of Australia Electoral Roll

Cottage number	Street	Occupation	Cottage number	Street	Occupation
	KING STREET			QUEEN STREET	
45	HEALEY Florence Marree	Home Duties	34	DREW Arthur	Rly Employee
	HEALEY John William	Engineman		DREW Gertrude Cecilia	Home Duties
	MORRISON James Duncan	Labourer	35	SULLY Mary Latham	Home Duties
46	SELLARS Hugh Amos	Fireman		SULLY William Edgar	Engineer
	SELLARS Mary Francis	Home Duties	36	HAVELBERG Herbert Silas	Mechanic
47	MAHAR Mary Veronica	Married		HAVELBERG Phyllis Josephine	Home Duties
	MAHAR Michael	SAR Guard	37	HAWKINS Edith May	Home Duties
	PRINCESS STREET			HAWKINS William Edward	Rly Employee
30	BROWN Elsie	Home Duties	38	WILLIAMS Edmund Archibald	Fireman
77	SWANN Gladys May	Home Duties		WILLIAMS Ida Mignonette	Home Duties
	SWANN John Herman	Fitter	39	REES Herbert Milford	Cleaner
78	HOOPER Edith Myrtle	Married		REES Sylviana	Married
	HOOPER William Charles	Labourer	41	STEVENS James Leo	Fitter
79	McLEAN Ellen May	Home Duties	42	FLAVEL Herbert Frederick	Guard
	McLEAN William Henry	Carpenter		FLAVEL Lydia Victoria	Home Duties
81	MARKS Edward	SAR Cleaner	43	NELSON Herbert James	Fireman
	MARKS Myrtle	Married		NELSON Myrtle Elizabeth	Married
82	DENT Harry	Fitter	44	EDDY Edwin	Fireman
	DENT Lillian Dorothy	Married		EDDY Ida Wilhelmina	Married
83	STUBBS Lily	Home Duties	46	THOMPSON Eileen Adella	Home Duties
	STUBBS William	Labourer		THOMPSON Walter Leslie	Fitter
84	BOTTGER Edith Alice	Home Duties	48	HERN Edward	Boilermaker
	BOTTGER Eleanor Victoria	Home Duties		HERN Gladys Evelyn	Home Duties
	BOTTGER Franz Carl	Painter	49	DONOVAN Joseph Benjamin	Labourer
85	TAPLEY Alfred George	Foreman		DONOVAN Ellen Monica	Home Duties
	TAPLEY Mary Janet	Home Duties	50	MAHONEY Leonard Augustine	Painter
86	HEIDENREICH Barbara	Home Duties		MAHONEY Elizabeth	Home Duties
	HEIDENREICH Berry L M	Fitter	52	MARAUN Maggie Elizabeth	Home Duties
88	HARRISON Denah Isabel	Home Duties		MARAUN Oscar August	Cleaner
	HARRISON Edmund Thomas	Clerk		PILGRIM Clement	Cleaner
90	McCOLIVE Gertrude Ann	Home Duties		PILGRIM Grace Catherine	Home Duties
	McCOLIVE Thomas Joseph	Lifter	53	SANDS Alice Maud	Married
91	KLEI Albert August	Labourer		SANDS Howard William	Engine Fitter
	KLEI Kathleen Emily	Home Duties	54	CRACKNELL James Joseph	Fireman
92	TREMBATH Clem	SAR Fireman	61	SEXTON Gertrude Anastasia	Home Duties
	TREMBATH Lily May	Home Duties		SEXTON Joseph Clement	Postal Clerk
94	CARROLL Percival John	SAR Clerk		SEXTON Margaret Anoria	Home Duties
	CARROLL Gertrude Esther	Home Duties		SEXTON Patrick F	Act Lifter
96	LOUTIT Amy Maude	Married	62	DICKER Rubina	Home Duties
	LOUTUT Charles William	Carpenter		DICKER Stanley Roderick	Rly Mechanic
98	BOTTGER George Deidrich	Clerk	63	DIENHOFF Leslie Alfred	Guard
100	JENKINS Mary	Home Duties		DIENHOFF Minnie Edith	Home Duties
	JENKINS Thomas Linnane	Cleaner	64	MORRELL Benjamin	Car Builder
101	MOBBS Margaret	Married		MORRELL Margaret	Shop Assistant
	MOBBS William Harold	Rly Employee		MORRELL Maud Mary	Home Duties
102	CLAYTON Mary Louisa	Home Duties	66	COONEY Esther Victoria	Home Duties
	CLAYTON Thomas Henry	Lifter		COONEY John Francis	Guard
103	VINCENT Clare	Home Duties	67	MURPHY Harold Alfred	Fireman
	VINCENT John Bewick	Labourer		MURPHY Mina May	Home Duties
104	BROWN Darrell Hy	Fireman	68	WENZEL Edith May	Home Duties
	BROWN Eliza Belle	Home Duties		WENZEL Elizabeth Jane	Home Duties
105	MORGAN Hazel	Home Duties		WENZEL John Frederick	Rly Guard
	MORGAN Lewis George	Fitter	69	JONES Adelaide Alison	Home Duties
	QUEEN STREET			JONES Donald Thomas	Labourer
	DORMAN Harold George	Rly Officer		JONES Thomas Heratio	Guard
	DORMAN Jean Armstrong	Home Duties	70	REYNOLDS Mabel Etta	Married
21	REYNOLDS Alma Mima	Confectioner	71	PEAKE Ada Lillian	Married
25	WYETT Doris Effie	Home Duties		PEAKE Horace Stanley	Fitter
			72	CARTER Eileen Ann G	Married
	QUEEN STREET			WRIGHT STREET	
73	WYETT Sidney Field	Shunter	99	USHER Gordon Samuel	Carpenter
74	MORRISON Charles Thomas	Fireman	115	EDMONDS Kathleen Mary	Home Duties
	MORRISON Ivy Florence	Home Duties	106	PARKINSON Alfred	SAR
75	TAYLOR Annie May	Married		PARKINSON Phyllis Gertrude	Home Duties
	TAYLOR Harold	Labourer	107	DOWLE Leonard Charles	Guard
76	MINAHAN Ida May	Home Duties		DOWLE Mabel Olive	Home Duties
95	DERRICK Edward	Cooper	108	SHEARER Dorothy Ella	Married
108	DREW William John	Conductor		SHEARER William Edward	Fitter

Cottage number	Street	Occupation	Cottage number	Street	Occupation
116	SUTTON Harold William	Cleaner	109	MEADOWS Arthur Henry	Fitter
	SUTTON Irene	Home Duties		VICTORY Ann	Married
	SUTTON Robert Leslie	Cleaner		VICTORY Timothy	Rly Employee
146	GARRED Albet John	Labourer	110	BLYTH Elizabeth Henrietta	Married
	GARRED Alma Bertha	Married		BLYTH George Leroy	Fireman
	RAILWAY TERRACE			VANNAN Elizabeth	Home Duties
21	BURTON Arthur Cyril Cox	Fitter	111	STEWART Alwin Ida	Home Duties
	BURTON Margaret Isobel	Home Duties		STEWART John William	Rly Guard
22	SNIDER Ethel Ann	Home Duties	112	SEDUNARY Vera Alice	Married
	SNIDER Harold Leslie	Labourer		SEDUNARY William Raymond	Fitter
23	GIBBIE Christopher Benedict	Fireman	113	MUSK Mary	Home Duties
	GIBBIE Mary Judith	Home Duties		MUSK William Henry	Labourer
24	PETERS Ida Caroline	Married	114	BRADBROOK William Berry	Labourer
	PETERS William	Fireman		TULLY Alice	Married
25	SCHUMANN Antonia Bertha	Home Duties		TULLY Llewellyn	Rly Employee
	SCHUMANN Frederick William	Blacksmith	117	GLENN Alexander James	Engine driver
26	HOUSTON Ada	Home Duties		GLENN Minnie Olive Myrtle	Home Duties
	HOUSTON Edward	Carpenter	118	SMITH Alice Rosy	Home Duties
27	WRIGHT Bessie Adams	Married		SMITH William Arthur	Contractor
	WRIGHT George Edward	Carpenter	120	SMITH William Arthur	Fitter
28	SEVENOAKS Edwin	Pumper		LYNAGH Imelda Zita	Married
	SEVENOAKS Jennie Elizabeth	Home Duties	121	LYNAGH James	Fitter
29	DICKINSON Dorothy May	Home Duties		PURDIE Annie	Home Duties
	DICKINSON Walter	Carpenter		PURDIE James	
31	LEY Florence May	Home Duties	123	PURDIE William	Rly Employee
	LEY John Arkell	Washer Out		KAVANAGH Fergus James	Fireman
32	ALLEN Florence	Home Duties	124	KAVANAGH Susana Amy	Home Duties
	ALLEN Percy John	Rly Employee		VAWSER Emma	Home Duties
33	USHER Florence Mary	Married	125	VAWSER Percy John	Fireman
	USHER Frederick William	SAR Lifter		GOSLING Mary	Married
51	CHANDLER Melva Evelyn	Home Duties	126	GOSLING Spencer Edward	Rly Employee
	CHANDLER Ostell Percy Francis	Cleaner		THOMSON Lancelot	Fitter
	ELLIS Annie Elizabeth	Married	145	THOMSON Thelma May	Married
	ELLIS Frederick James	Cleaner		ROSSER David Lewis	Loco cleaner
62	DUNN Elza Susuan	Home Duties	147	ROSSER Ida Vera	Married
80	CUNNINGHAM Cecil Joseph	Porter	149	CHAPMAN Margaret Mary	Married
	CUNNINGHAM Louise Victoria	Home Duties		WEBB Annie	Home Duties
87	PRATT Albert Richard	Painter	150	WEBB John Stanley	Fitter
	PRATT Arthur Britton	Labourer		THOMAS Clarice Evelyn	Married
	PRATT Coralie Angela Jane	Home Duties	151	THOMAS William Archibald	Engineer
122	DAENKE Catherine	Married		REEVE Frank Augustus	Painter
	DAENKE Frederick	Rly Employee		REEVE Nessie	Home Duties
	BARTLETT Edwin	Rly Employee			



Poured Cement Cottage – Hill Street
Photo - Lionel Noble Collection



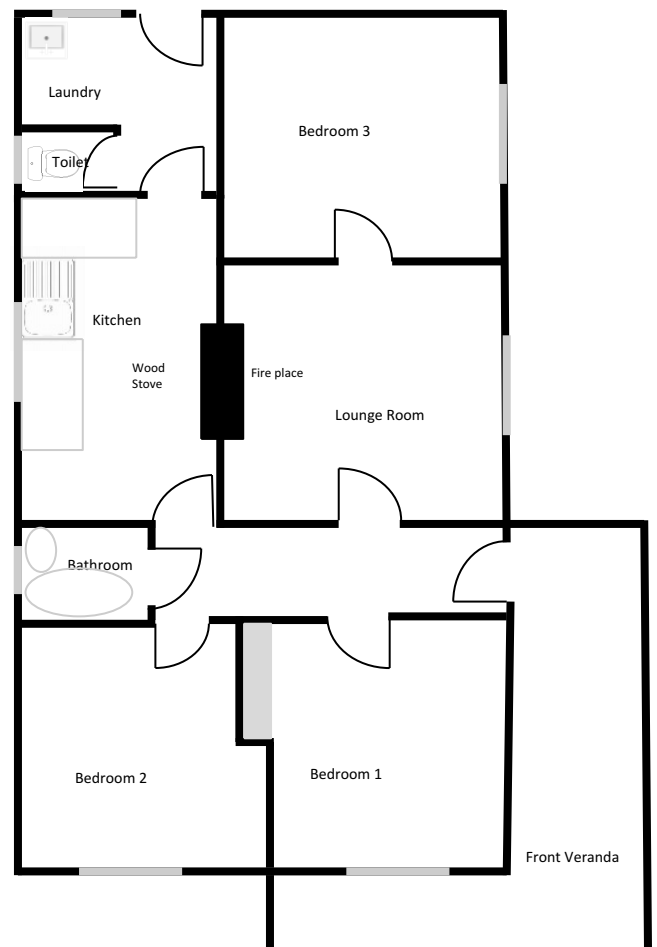
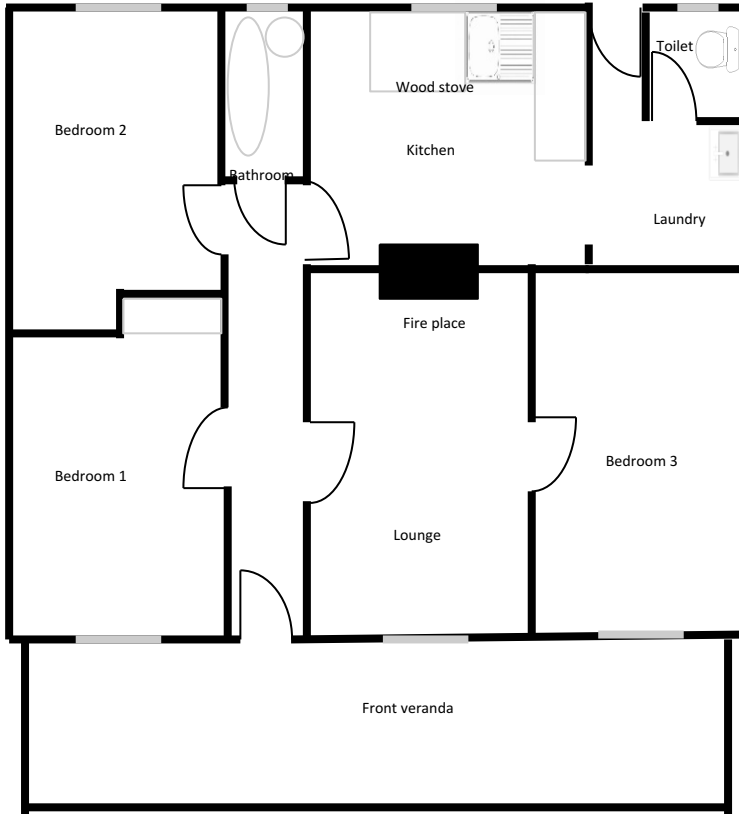
Poured Cement Cottages
Photo - SLSA – Peterborough Collection Image B63712

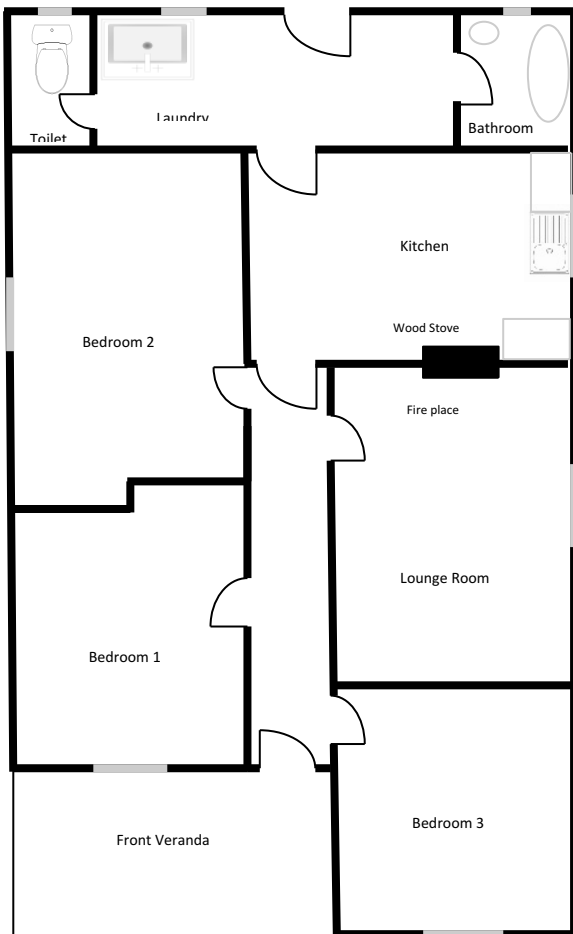


Building of poured cement houses – 1925
Photo - SLSA – Peterborough Collection Image B 48876



View of Railway Cottages looking north
Houses in Buxton Cres and Wright St at front with men at a quarry in foreground
Photo - SLSA – Peterborough Collection Image B 322258

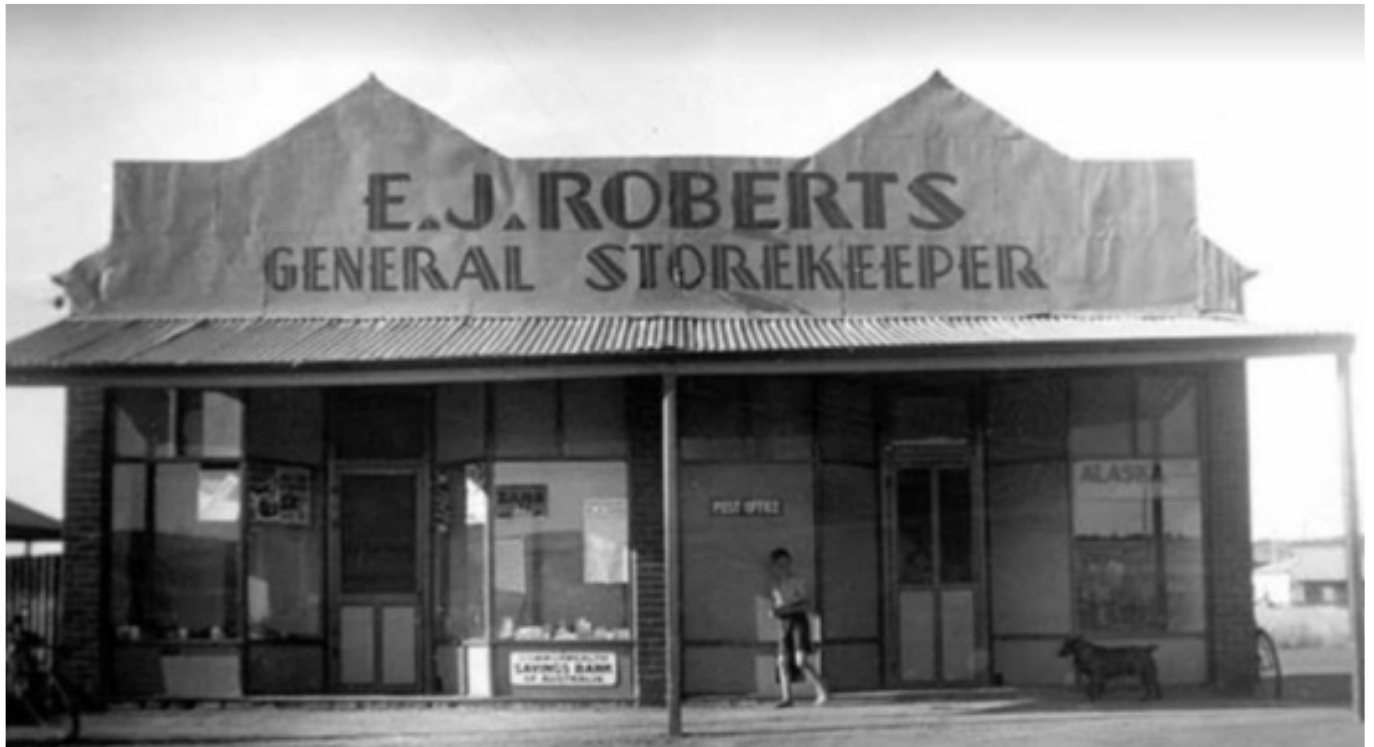




Original built in cupboard in Bedroom 1
Photo - realestate.com.au

Original wood stove and kitchen cupboard
Photo - realestate.com.au

Original wash trough
Photo - realestate.com.au



*West Shop – Queen Street - 1948
Photo - Peterborough Library History Room*



*West Shop – Queen Street - 1975
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*